



Beeline bike compass

Beeline is a new bike navigator that points riders in the right direction depending on how far they have to travel. <http://digit.in/BeelineC>



Hugo Barra quits

Hugo Barra announced that he is leaving the Xiaomi in February. <http://digit.in/HugoBarra>

Smartphone Cameras

HOW WE TESTED

Our tests began with shooting with each of these smartphone cameras individually, to find out how responsive and spontaneous they seemed. We shot with each of these smartphones without initially taking into account the comparison parameters. This gave us a good reference in terms of how each of these smartphone cameras fared, in terms of shooting in different environments, the responsiveness of the camera apps, features available, load and save times. This also allowed us to figure out any discrepancies in each of these cameras, which laid the foundation for the comparison.

Alongside, we also figured out the strengths and weaknesses of each of these

cameras. Following these, we took all of the cameras together to shoot in the same scenario. Our three primary shooting grounds included outdoor and indoor in terms of well-lit zones, and low light. We took three most popular situations of shooting into account to test the versatility of each of these smartphone cameras.

Our primary grounds of inspection involved how accurate each of these cameras were in terms of colour accuracy, and how well each of these cameras adjusted white balance. We also included comparative analysis in terms of the details that each produces, the sharpness that each of these cameras retain, and how each deals with noise. While

some opted for aggressive noise reduction that tends to soften images, others retained better sharpness and more noise, which can be dealt with in post-processing. The dynamic range of colours were also taken into account to inspect the quality of colour reproduction.

Noise reduction also played a key factor in deciding the outcome of this comparison. We examined how aggressive the noise reduction algorithms were, how useable were the photographs even with the noise reduction, and the biggest impact could be seen in low light situations. The noise levels in photographs also gave us a good idea in terms of how

We also took into account all of the above to make our test reasonably comprehensive.

WINNERS

BEST PERFORMER

The Honor 6X is the best performing budget smartphone camera in this comparison. It proves to be the most versatile smartphone camera module among the five here, and its dual-camera mechanism helps in producing better details in photographs, along with adding background defocus effects. It produces good colour accuracy, along with very good noise suppression. It retains colour vibrancy quite well across most lighting situations, and also produces good photographs in low light. The dynamic range of colours is also the best in its class, and photographs retain good sharpness. Adding to that is good pricing by Honor, along with reliable overall performance of the smartphone. It also comes with a reasonably appealing body, an overall ergonomic

form factor, making this an attractive overall proposition in the sub-18k price segment. The Honor 6X aced the charts by being the best performing camera smartphone here.



Honor 6X

BEST BUY

The Xiaomi Redmi Note 4 walks away with the Best Buy award in this comparison. There is a slight sense of oversaturation, particularly



Xiaomi Redmi Note 4

when there are predominant bold colours in frames. Many, though, would like the vividness in terms of colours here. Low light shots by the Redmi Note 4 are also reasonably useable, and with a fast, responsive camera app, the Xiaomi Redmi Note 4 is among the most reliable and versatile budget smartphone camera among the five compared here. It also provides a considerable improvement in terms of imaging over its popular predecessor, the Xiaomi Redmi Note 3, and contrary to the latter offering sublime performance for its price, the Redmi Note 4 attempts to provide a better balance in terms of performance, imaging, display, design, end-user experience, and battery life. With all of this combined, the Xiaomi Redmi Note 4 is totally value for money, making this the Best Buy in this smartphone camera comparison test.